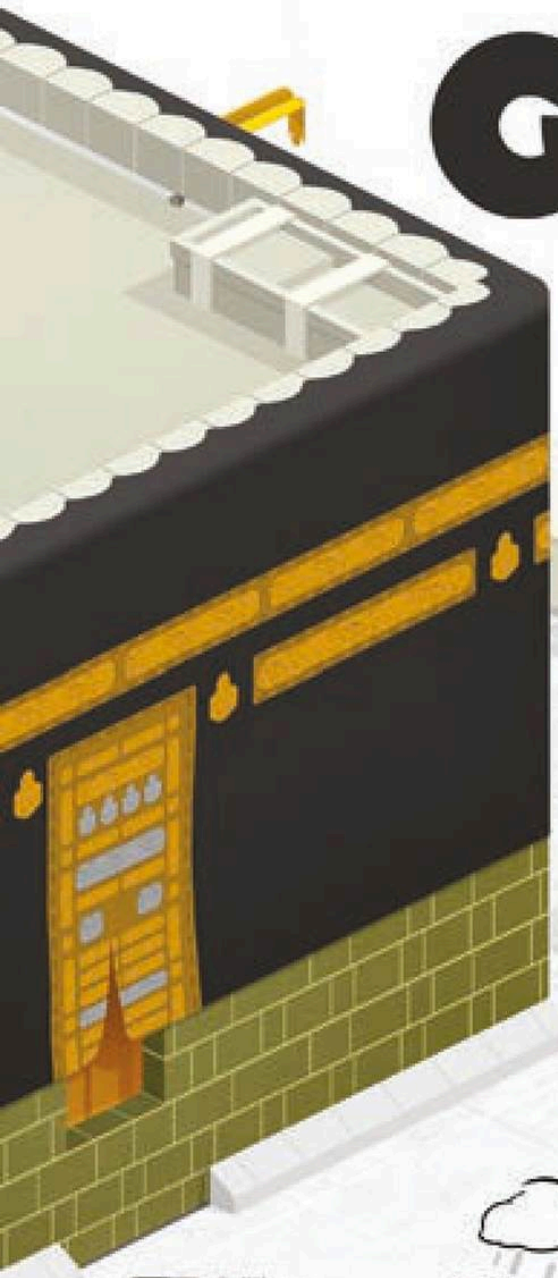
the Illustrated Guide to & Hajj Umrah



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BDouin

ALBAYT

Your Illustrated Guide to Hajj and ‘Umrah

Discover every step of the pilgrimage rituals through beautiful and detailed illustrations.

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Noredine Allam

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Yaqub Leenen

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Karim Allam

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بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

In the name of Allah, the All-Merciful, the Most Compassionate

"All praises are due to Allah who guided us to Islam and chose us to be part of the best community of mankind. We ask Him to allow us to accomplish all the deeds He loves and is pleased with, and to protect us from doing what He abhors and what angers Him."

Indeed, there are plenty of books about the pilgrimage available to the English-speaking audience. Some of these are of particularly high quality.

However, the book you have in hand is meant to offer something different and it will, with the help of Allah, contribute to the acceptance of your acts of worship and enhance the quality of your experience in Makkah and Madinah.

Our goal is to describe your upcoming journey by blending a tour guide's perspective with excerpts from renowned contemporary scholars' books*, presented through vivid illustrations. Each phase of your pilgrimage will be narrated, explained, and visually depicted in detail.

We believe that anticipating potential challenges will better prepare you to overcome them. This book offers clear illustrations and maps to guide you through your rituals, along with a concise compilation of supplications at the end.

May Allah grant us the best conditions to fulfill the pilgrimage, which is one of the pillars of Islam.

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PREFACE

About the intention

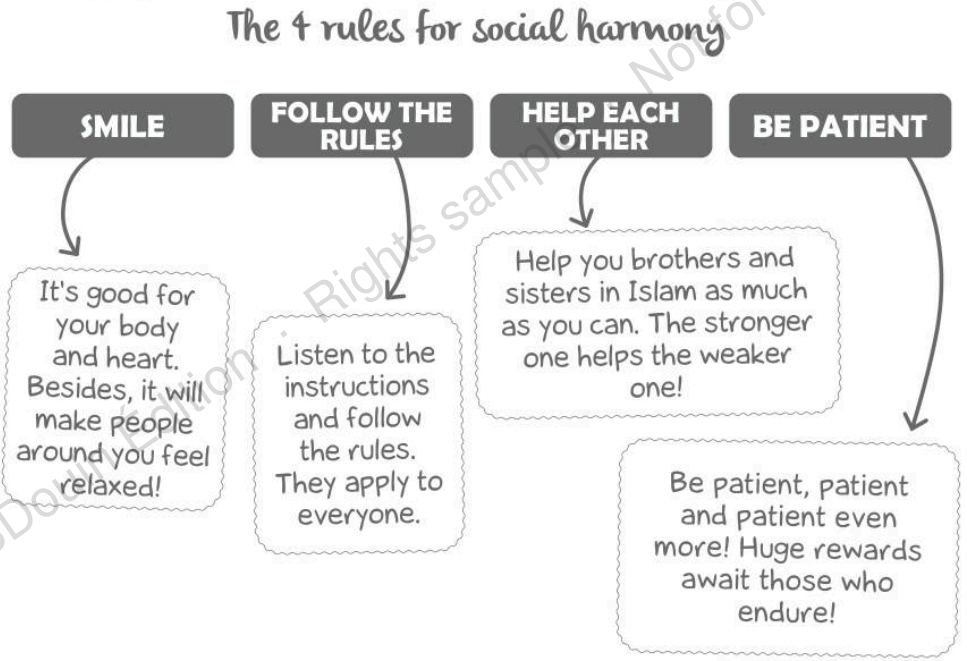
Your intention in accomplishing this journey should be entirely devoted to Allah only. Be aware that the entire acceptance of your pilgrimage depends on it. Also, make sure to finance your stay with honestly earned money.

Be patient

You will need patience!

Indeed, the organisation of such a gathering is a huge challenge for the Saudi authorities, for two main reasons:

- **The massive number of pilgrims:** millions of people gather in one place at the same time
- **The huge diversity in the pilgrims' origins:** dozens of different nationalities and languages, hundreds of traditions and customs come together.



This guide is a description of the Hajj and 'Umrah rituals, according to the Tamattu' ritual, which is the way the Prophet ﷺ has recommended his Companions to perform it during his farewell pilgrimage. It consists in leaving one's state of Ihraam after having performed 'Umrah in the three months of Hajj (Shawwaal, Dhul-Qa'dah and the first 9 days of Dhul-Hijjah) and returning to normal life. Then, on the 8th of Dhul-Hijjah, the pilgrim wears the Ihraam outfit and enters the state of Ihraam again, to perform the Hajj.

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1

GETTING PREPARED

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1/ THE REQUIRED BUDGET TO COMPLETE THE HAJJ OR THE 'UMRAH*

The amount of money needed to perform Hajj or 'Umrah is significant and requires careful budget planning for most average households to be able to save it.
This money should be earned lawfully by working in an activity permitted by Islam or obtained through a gift or inheritance.

It is advisable for those who wish to perform the pilgrimage to pay off their debts.
The person who owes money is considered financially incapable of performing the Hajj until he has repaid his debt except in the following cases:
• Performing Hajj will not delay the reimbursement of the debt; in this case, it is even an obligation for the person to perform this pillar of Islam.
• if the creditor authorises the person to perform Hajj.

REMARKS
Don't forget that you will have administrative tasks to perform:
- request a leave from work.
- if needed, renew your passport and/or your family members' passports.
NOTE that your passport must still have a validity of at least 6 months AFTER your return date.
- Foreigners residing outside their homeland may have to provide a valid residence permit or similar.
- Check these document validity dates and make sure they are still valid.
- Enquire about the required mandatory vaccinations and have them done.

2/ SELECTING THE TRAVEL AGENCY

Your choice must be based on several tangible parametres:

• **The agency experience and professionalism:** the travel agent should be experienced, have a valid commercial registration, and be an accredited travel professional.
It is your right to ask to see all their supporting documents.
• **Quality of service:** look them up on the Internet and read the reviews. This way you will be able to select the proper agent who provides quality travel services.
• **Full transparency on the services provided:** request a copy of your contract describing the services in detail and ask for a receipt for any payment made.

* Outside the Hajj period, it is now possible to travel to the holy places on a simple tourist visa that you can obtain online, without having to go through an agency. In this case, you will have to book your airway tickets, accommodation and local transportation yourself.
The latest version of the Nusuk mobile application allows you to book domestic flights, as well as your bus or train trips in Saudi Arabia.

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3/ SELECTING THE PACKAGE

Please note that the Hajj and 'Umrah packages have multiple options which may be subject to constraints and differ according to several criteria:

What are your constraints?

- **Your dates and duration of your leave:** if you are a company employee, you will be bound by your leave duration and dates.
- **Your budget:** it will determine the duration of the stay and the level of comfort.

The offered package will be evaluated according to the following criteria:

- The duration: be aware, however, that the outbound and inbound dates may be subject to change up to a few days before departure or return. This is beyond the travel agency's control.
- The visit to Madinah can be either before or after 'Umrah: this does not impact the price, but it is good to know.
- Direct flights or with a stopover: it is strongly recommended to choose direct flights, to avoid a long journey and additional fatigue.
- During or outside the month of Ramadan: 'Umrah during Ramadan is more expensive than outside that month.
- The distance between the hotels and the holy mosques: let the travel agent pinpoint the hotels on a map. Be aware that 700 metres can be a long way and tiring if you walk that distance several times a day, in very hot weather!
- The 'aziziyah package: the 'aziziyah district in Makkah is located five kilometres from the Makkah holy Mosque and this type of package is often cheaper.
- The standard of hotels: apart from well-known chain hotels, the number of stars does not always reflect the actual level of comfort and cleanliness of the hotel.
- The number of people per room.
- Are meals included in the package: breakfast only, half board, full board?
- Is the sheep to be sacrificed for Hajj included?

The quality of on site services may vary from one Mutawwif (local service provider) to another, without your agency having any control on this.

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GOOD TO KNOW
The length of stay is the time between your outbound and inbound flights, so from the time of taking off up to landing, on your return flight.
Thus, the length of stay can be announced as 15 days, while you might leave the first day at 11:55 p.m., and the last day of your return might be at 12:05 a.m.
The rule is: "a day started is a day counted!"
These are the standards applied in the tourism industry.

4/ THE PHYSICAL PREPARATION

What should you expect to physically endure during your stay?
• To walk long distances: if you are overweight, this may cause friction between your legs, and/or serious physical fatigue if you are not prepared and it may cause blisters on your feet if you don't wear proper shoes.
- So, try to lose weight before Hajj if you are overweight.
- Walk distances from 5 to 7 kilometres a couple of times during the weeks prior to your departure.
- Choose comfortable sandals that provide good support and won't slip off.
• To undergo a change in your diet: which may cause gastric discomfort.
Be careful in your food choices and don't take any risk. If you have the smallest doubt about the freshness of food, avoid it.
• To experience extreme heat: remember to constantly hydrate yourself, by drinking water or herbal teas regularly; avoid overindulging in sweet carbonated or caffeinated soft drinks.
- Don't expose yourself to the sun: the Arabian sun hits hard!
• To suffer from the effects of pollution: by inhaling exhaust gases, dust, etc.
Wear a mask or scarf to protect your nostrils, except when you are in a state of Ihraam because the mask is prohibited the same way as the niqaab is for women.
• To get little sleep: often on arrival, excitement is at its peak due to the change in climate, pace and environment.
It will therefore be necessary to ensure:
- to have a proper schedule for bedtime and stick to it as much as possible.
- to avoid discussions late at night.
- to set rules with your roommates in the hotel room or tent.
- to schedule purchases and other non-essential shopping at convenient times such as in the morning, instead of delaying them until late at night.

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5/ LEARN AND INFORM YOURSELF

It is mandatory for a Muslim to learn his/her religion rituals, and even more so for a pilgrim who is preparing for Hajj or 'Umrah. The validity or nullity of his/her acts of worship depends on it.

You must therefore read books, watch videos, but also learn the few supplications to recite once at destination.

It is also recommended to review the way you perform your prayer (Salaat) and check its conformity to the prophetic tradition (Sunnah). Indeed, the rewards announced for those who perform prayers within the Sacred Mosque of Makkah, or Madinah Mosque, are huge:

100,000 prayers for those performed in Makkah, and 1,000 for those performed in Madinah!

But on the other hand, you may not obtain these rewards if you were to make serious mistakes or failures in performing them!

The same applies to Hajj and 'Umrah. It would be sad to invest so much effort in performing the rituals, only to lose the rewards, because you haven't performed them correctly!
Some pilgrims mistakenly think that some rules are just details when in fact they may be pillars of rituals, that if neglected may result in the nullification of the Hajj or 'Umrah.

The golden rule during the pilgrimage is therefore:

Perform your rituals in accordance with the Quran and the Sunnah and stay away from any type of innovation!
The Prophet ﷺ said:

"Follow my example when you perform your [Hajj and 'Umrah] rituals."
[Narrated by Muslim]

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6/ WHAT TO PACK IN YOUR SUITCASE?

Packing your suitcase will probably take a few days. Each element is important and necessary!

Here is a fit for purpose list:

- your Islamic will in case of sudden death.
- a large soft foldable bag that you can use on your return, if your suitcase is not big enough to hold all your purchases
- an e-reader, easy to transport, to look up your books and audios
- a small backpack to get you to Mina with only the essential things
- a small fabric or plastic bag to put your sandals in when you enter the Mosque
- a shoulder bag for your documents, sunglasses, cash, mobile phone, etc.
- a large bedsheet and/or a floor mat; given the hot temperatures, bringing a sleeping bag with you is not necessary
- light everyday clothes to wear after the rituals
- A clean Ihraam outfit (washed so that it is comfortable to wear, but without using scented fabric softener or detergent)
- a travel first aid kit containing: scent free Vaseline for irritations, 500mg paracetamol tablets, sanitiser spray, medical bandages and plasters, small scissors, water spray, etc.
- hygiene and toiletries: toothbrush, toothpaste, shampoo and shower gel in travel format, etc.
- an unlocked mobile phone to be able to install a local SIM card: it is recommended to take a smartphone equipped with GPS. You may as well use your usual telecom provider if you subscribed to a cheap roaming package.
- a universal adapter for your phone charger: Saudi Arabia has adopted three-pin UK-style sockets, but you may find other types of sockets.
- a small torch
- dried fruits and energy bars, your favourite snacks…



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7/ HAVE CASH AT HAND

Part of your costs will not be covered in the agency services. This includes for example: meals, taxi rides, personal purchases, telephone and internet… We advise you to budget around 100 Saudi riyals (SAR) per person per day, for your miscellaneous expenses.

It is possible to pay with some of the bank cards or withdraw cash from ATMs but these may be crowded and the commissions and exchange rate you will pay are uncertain.
The most common way is to change currencies through the various exchange offices located in shopping malls or on main streets.

At per end of 2025 exchange rates, one British pound (£ 1.00) equals to approximatively SAR 5.00, so SAR 1.00 equals to approx. £ 0.20.
As for USD 1, it is always equivalent to +/- SAR 3.75. So, SAR 1 is equal to approx. USD 0.26.
To convert prices from SAR to USD off the top of your head, divide the riyal price roughly by 4. To obtain British pound prices, divide the riyal price by 5.

8/ PRICES OF SOME COMMON ITEMS

- Flat bread: 1 sar
- Sliced bread: 5-7 sar
- 200 ml juice: 2 sar
- 330 ml bottle of water: 1 to 2 sar
- Zamzam water is always available for free in the holy Mosque of Makkah and the Madinah Mosque.
- 300 ml soft drink: 3 to 4 sar
- espresso or coffee: 8 sar or more
- rice-chicken meal (1 person): 20 to 35 sar
- fast food meal: 20 to 35 sar
- a trip of 4 to 5 kilometres by taxi: starting from 10 SAR

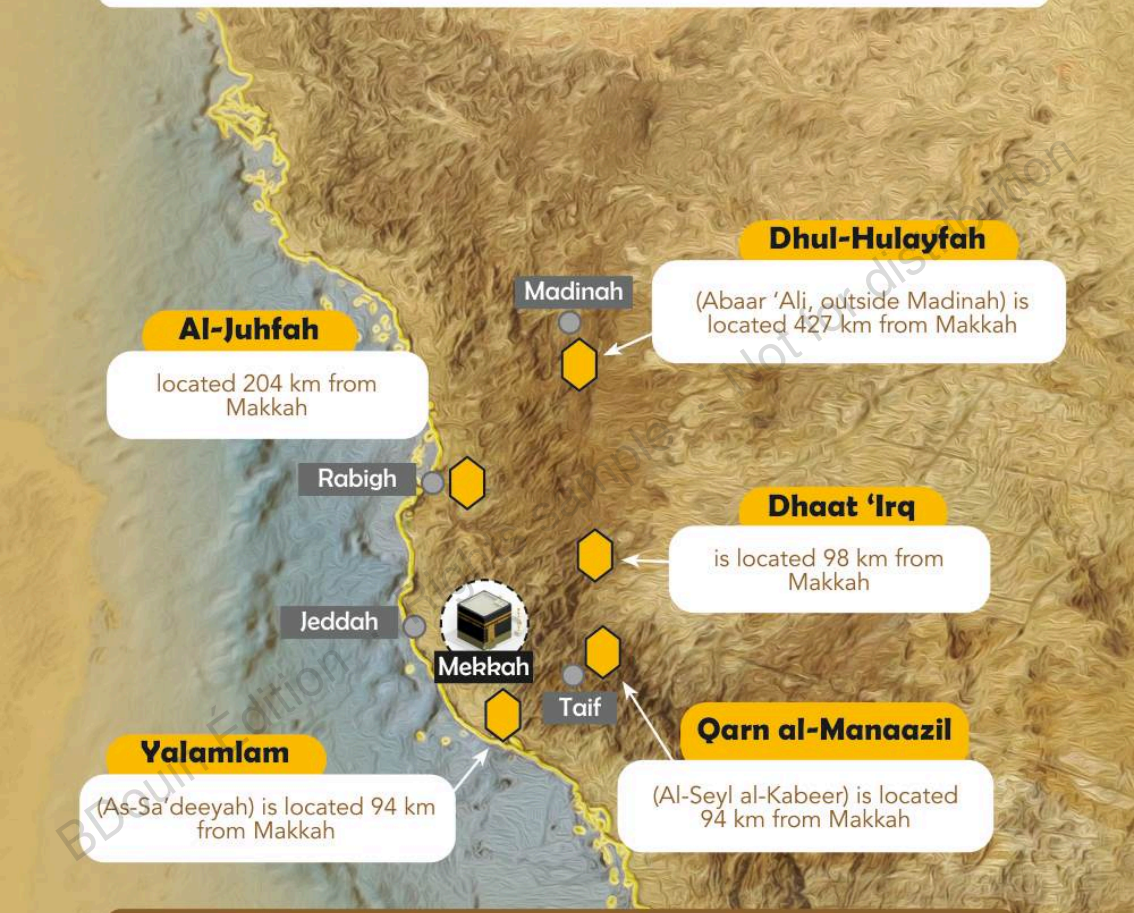
This price can be tenfold during the pilgrimage, or at peak hours when there is a lot of traffic and demand.

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THERE ARE 5 PLACES OF MIQAAT

Any person passing through the place of Miqaat, or next to it with the intention of performing the pilgrimage (Hajj) or the pious visit ('Umrah), must have the intention of entering the state of Ihraam and wear the dedicated outfit at that place.



Most pilgrims from Europe or North America enter the state of Ihraam:

- either on the plane, approximately 20 to 30 minutes before landing at Jeddah airport, if they are going to Makkah directly
- or in Dhul-Hulayfah, if they visit Madinah before going to Makkah.

IMPORTANT: Anyone who travels beyond these points without entering the state of Ihraam will have to return there to do so. If he or she can't do so, he/she will have to sacrifice an animal and distribute its meat to the needy in the sacred perimeter of Makkah (al-Haram).

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2

Entering the state of
IHRAAM

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1/ ENTERING THE STATE OF IHRAAM



It is authorised to perform the washing ritual and wear the Ihraam outfit before reaching the Miqaat.
The pilgrim may wear his Ihraam garment before reaching the point of entry into the sacred perimeter (Miqaat), and he can even do it at home, as the Prophet ﷺ and his Companions did it.
As for pilgrims traveling to Hajj or 'Umrah by plane, they have the option of boarding dressed in their Ihraam.
However, they will only pronounce the intention to enter the state of Ihraam shortly before the Miqaat, making sure not to go beyond it before having uttered the intention.

At the Miqaat, it is recommended (Sunnah) for a man:

- to perform a ritual washing (ghusl)
- cut his nails, shave his armpits and pubic hair, trim his moustache (without shaving or trimming his beard)
- to perfume his body, head and beard. He must not perfume his clothes though.
- then, to put on the Ihraam outfit which consists of two pieces of fabric: the loincloth (izâr) around the waist and the upper piece (ridâ') which should cover both shoulders.

BEWARE: It is mandatory to cover both shoulders. The right shoulder is only uncovered during the first tawaaf of 'Umrah.

As for the woman, it is recommended for her:

Once she arrives at the point of Miqaat, to perform the washing ritual (ghusl) even if she is in her menstruation period or has postpartum bleedings.
She can wear her regular clothes as long as they fully cover her body and do not have embellishments.
She is not allowed to wear a veil attached to her face (like the niqaab), nor gloves, but she can wear a veil placed on top of her head that she can lower to cover her face when she is in the presence of men who are not her relatives (mahaarim).
There is no preferred colour for her outfit, but she should avoid white so as not to resemble men.

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2/ The actual entry into the state of Ihraam

Ihraam is the act of pronouncing the intention to start the rituals of Hajj or 'Umrah. If the time for mandatory prayer has come, it is recommended to first pray and then enter the state of Ihraam.
The pilgrim then says aloud, facing Makkah:

لَبَّيْكَ اَللَّهُمَّ عُمْرَةً

Labbayk Allaahumma 'Umratan.
"I answer your call, O Allah, by performing this 'Umrah."

Whoever wishes his 'Umrah to be valid as part of his Hajj (according to the Tamattu' ritual) must perform the 'Umrah during the three months of Hajj, which are Shawwâl, Dhul-Qa'dah and the first nine days of Dhul-Hijjah, then perform Hajj in the same year, during the same trip (without returning home in-between).

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3/ Pronouncing the condition

The pilgrim can pronounce a condition just before pronouncing the talbiyah (see opposite), if he fears that something might prevent him from completing his 'Umrah or Hajj, such as illness or danger. He should then recite the wording taught to us by the Prophet ﷺ:

اللَّهُمَّ مَحِلِّي حَيْثُ حَبَسْتَنِي

Allaahhumma mahillee haythu habastanee.

"O Allah, I will quit my state of Ihraam wherever You stop me."

Narrated by Al-Bukharee and Muslim

If the pilgrim has pronounced this condition and something prevents him from completing the rituals or if he becomes ill, he is allowed to leave the state of Ihraam related to his Hajj or 'Umrah. He won't have to sacrifice an animal, nor perform Hajj or 'Umrah in compensation. If it is his first Hajj though, he will have to come back to perform this mandatory act of worship.

4/ Prohibited acts related to the state of Ihraam ⛔

It is prohibited FOR MEN AND WOMEN:

- shave or trim hair, cut nails or remove skin
- to wear perfume, whatever the type of perfume
- to ask a woman for marriage for oneself or for somebody else, to marry whether yourself or to arrange a marriage for somebody else. Sexual intercourse or the preliminaries of it are also prohibited.
- to hunt game or participate in hunting.

It is prohibited FOR MEN ONLY:

- to wear clothes that fit the shape of the body, such as shirts, trousers, socks or anything similar.
- to cover his head with something that is in direct contact with it, such as a turban tied around the head or a mask. However, he is allowed to use an umbrella, carry personal belongings on his head, or wear a belt, a watch and sunglasses.

It is prohibited FOR WOMEN ONLY:

- to wear gloves
- to cover her face with a burqa', a niqaab or any other veil which is attached to her face. On the other hand, she is allowed to cover her face with a khimaar (veil placed on the top of her head which can be lowered over her face), when she is in the presence of men who are not her relatives (not mahaarim).

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Whoever intentionally violates one of the prohibitions of Ihraam, such as shaving or trimming his/her hair, cutting his/her nails, wearing perfume; covering his head or wearing clothes or kissing his wife with desire; for a woman, wearing gloves or niqaab, must compensate for each one of the offenses by doing one of the following things:

- fast for three days continuously or separately
- feed six poor persons by providing them each 1.5 kg of food (i.e. half of a Saac)
- slaughter a sheep and distribute the meat to the poor in the sacred perimeter (al-Haram).

However, anyone who violates the prohibitions due to **forgetfulness, ignorance or by force**, does not have to compensate.

Whoever asks a woman to marry him commits a sin and should repent but does not have to compensate for that.
Concerning the compensation for sexual intercourse or hunting during Hajj or 'Umrah, refer to religious opinions on the subject.

5/ Prononcer la *Talbiyah*



It is recommended (Sunnah) for a man to raise his voice while pronouncing the talbiyah, and to repeat it as often as possible saying:

لَبَّيْكَ اللَّهُمَّ لَبَّيْكَ
لَبَّيْكَ لاَ شَرِيكَ لَكَ لَبَّيْكَ
إِنَّ الحَمْدَ وَالنِّعْمَةَ لَكَ وَالمُلْكُ
لاَ شَرِيكَ لَكَ

**Labbayk Allaahumma labbayka,
labbayka laa shareeka Laka labbayka.
inna l-hamda wan-ni'mata,
Laka wal-mulku. Laa shareeka Laka.**

"Here I am, O Allah, here I am. Here I am, You have no partner, here I am.
Truly all praises, grace and sovereignty belong to You. You have no partner."

As for the woman,
it is recommended (Sunnah) for her to pronounce the talbiyah without raising her voice, so that only women next to her can hear it.
You should pronounce the talbiyah from the moment you enter the state of Ihraam until you begin turning around the Ka'bah (or according to another opinion: until you see the first buildings of Makkah).

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TABLE OF PILLARS, OBLIGATIONS AND RECOMMENDED ACTS (SUNAN) OF THE 'UMRAH

PILLARS	OBLIGATIONS	RECOMMENDED ACTS (Sunan)
Failure to perform what is considered a pillar makes the 'Umrah invalid.	Failure to fulfil an obligation must be compensated by slaughtering an animal and distributing its meat in the sacred perimeter of Makkah (haram).	Whoever performs an act confirmed by the Sunnah obtains its reward; if he doesn't perform it, he has not committed a mistake and doesn't have to compensate.
1- Enter the state of Ihraam which is the intention to begin the rituals.	1- Entering the state of Ihraam at the Miqaat	All other acts quoted in the next chapter like drinking Zamzam water and pouring it on your head, touching the Black stone...
2- The seven laps around the Ka'bah (tawaaf).	2- Shave or trim your hair	
3-Walking back and forth between the Mounts Safaa and Marwah (Sa'ee).		

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- **Not performing a pillar** of Hajj or 'Umrah results in the Hajj or 'Umrah being invalid. If it is the first mandatory Hajj, one must come back to perform it again. If any pillar of the 'Umrah performed as part of the Hajj was neglected, one must perform this 'Umrah again.

- **Whoever neglects an obligation** of Hajj or 'Umrah must slaughter a sheep, or the seventh of a cow or of a camel and distribute the meat to the poor in the sacred perimeter (haram).

- **Whoever performs an act** of the Sunnah has the reward for it and if he doesn't, he commits no sin.

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3

The Steps to perform 'UMRAH

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Note: Detailed pictures are available in the chapter of the Hajj rituals.

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If possible, perform a ritual washing (ghusl) upon entering Makkah, and enter during daytime.

6/ Enter the Sacred Mosque of Makkah



Remember to step into the Mosque with your right foot first and say:

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَسَلِّمْ
اللَّهُمَّ افْتَحْ لِي أَبْوَابَ رَحْمَتِكَ

Allaahumma salli 'alaa Muhammadin wa sallim, Allaahumma ftah lee abwaaba rahmatik.

"O Allah, pray and send your mercy upon Muhammad, O Allah, open the doors of Your mercy to me."

You can also add:

أَعُوذُ بِاللهِ العَظِيمِ وَبِوَجْهِهِ الكَرِيمِ وَسُلْطَانِهِ القَدِيمِ
مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ.

A'oodhu billaahil-'Aazheemi, wa bi Wajhihil-Kareemi, wa Sultaanih il-Qadeemi, minash-Shaytaan ir-Rajeem.

"I seek protection by Allah the Greatest, by His Noble face and His Eternal Sovereignty, against Satan the accursed."

When the pilgrim sees the Ka'bah for the first time,
he may raise his hands as Ibn 'Abbas ﷺ did. He can also recite the following supplication as authentically reported from 'Umar ﷺ:

اللَّهُمَّ أَنْتَ السَّلامُ
وَمِنْكَ السَّلامُ فَحَيِّنَا رَبَّنَا بِالسَّلامِ.

Allaahumma Antassa-salaamu, wa Minkas-salaamu fa hayyinaa Rabbanaa bis-salaam.

"O Allah, You are Peace, from You comes Peace, O Lord, keep us in Peace."

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7/ Start the tawaf

See pictures pages 39 to 41



You will start the circles from the Black stone which you will kiss, if possible, while keeping the Ka'bah on your left side. If you can't kiss the Black Stone, you can touch it with your right hand and kiss your hand. If you can neither kiss it nor touch it, then you extend your right hand in its direction, without kissing your hand afterwards. You then say:

بِسْمِ اللهِ . اللهُ أَكْبَرُ

Bismi Llaahi. Allaahu Akbar!

"In the name of Allah. Allah is the Greatest!"

It is Sunnah (part of the prophetic tradition) **to uncover the right shoulder** (idhtibaa') **during the seven laps upon arrival** (tawaaf al-qudoom).



To uncover your right shoulder, put the middle of the upper piece of fabric (ridaa') under your armpit and throw the end over your left shoulder.

8/ The first three laps



It is Sunnah **to run quietly in the first three laps of the first tawaaf upon arrival.** Running consists here in doing small and quick steps. As for the woman, she should walk at a normal pace during the seven laps.

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